

HUM 2101: Sociology and Disaster Management

Significance of Sociology, Social Structure of Bangladesh

Week 5-6

Sociology

Definition of Sociology: Sociology is about studying how people behave when they are together in groups, and how societies work

Dorothy Smith's Definition: Dorothy Smith says that society is like a big ongoing concert or coordination of what people do together.

Identity and Groups: Groups are collections of people who come together because they share interests or goals, like friends, teams, or clubs. Identity is what makes you who you are, including your beliefs, traits, and how you see yourself.

Patterns in Interaction: When people interact (talk, work, or play together), they follow certain ways that are like patterns . These patterns can be rules or habits that everyone understands without always needing to say them out loud.

Areas of sociology

There are seven areas of sociology that includes nearly every topic.

Social Organization: It's how a society is structured and how different groups of people interact.

Social Psychology: This studies how people behave in groups and how it affects them.

Social Change : It's about how societies change over time—how things like values and behaviors evolve.

Human Ecology : This looks at how humans fit into their natural and social environments.

Population and Demographics : It's about studying groups of people and their common characteristics, like age or location.

Applied Sociology : This uses sociology to solve real-world problems or understand everyday situations.

Sociological Methods and Research: These are the ways sociologists gather and analyze information to learn about people and society.

Key Terms of Sociology

Culture: Culture is everything that makes up the way of life for a group of people. It includes their language, values (what they think is important), and physical things they use.

Society: Society is a group of people who live in the same place and are connected through jobs, money, and government.

Values: Values are ideas that people in a group think are good or important.

Norms: In sociology, norms are shared guidelines that rule acceptable behavior within a society, guiding individuals in their interactions.

Globalization: Globalization is when ideas, resources, and people are connected worldwide, not just locally.

Socialization: Socialization is how people learn the roles, rules, and values they need to be part of a group or society.

Conflict: Conflict is when people fight over things they don't have enough of, like money or power, and there are no rules to settle the fight peacefully.

Bureaucracy: Bureaucracy is a type of organization that has strict rules and a clear chain of command to work as efficiently as possible

Key Terms of Sociology

Social Stratification: Social stratification is the hierarchical arrangement of individuals or groups in a society based on factors like wealth, power, education, and prestige, leading to unequal access to resources and opportunities.

Caste: In sociology, caste is a social system that divides people into hierarchical groups based on birth, often determining their roles and status in society.

Class: Your class is about how much you can achieve in life, like through education and work.

Socioeconomic Status (SES): SES shows how high or low you are in society based on things like how much money you make, your education, and your job.

Sex: Sex is whether you're a man or a woman, based on your body.

Gender: Gender is about how society expects men and women to act and behave.

Significance of Sociology

Identifying Social Needs: Sociology helps us see what people in society need, like better healthcare or education.

Understanding Social Problems: It lets us study and understand problems in society, like poverty or crime, and why they happen.

Promoting Welfare: Governments use sociology to help groups like tribal communities, improving their lives.

Unity in Diversity: Sociology teaches us about different cultures and religions, promoting unity and understanding among people.

Changing Perspectives: It helps us see criminals and others in society differently, understanding why they do what they do.

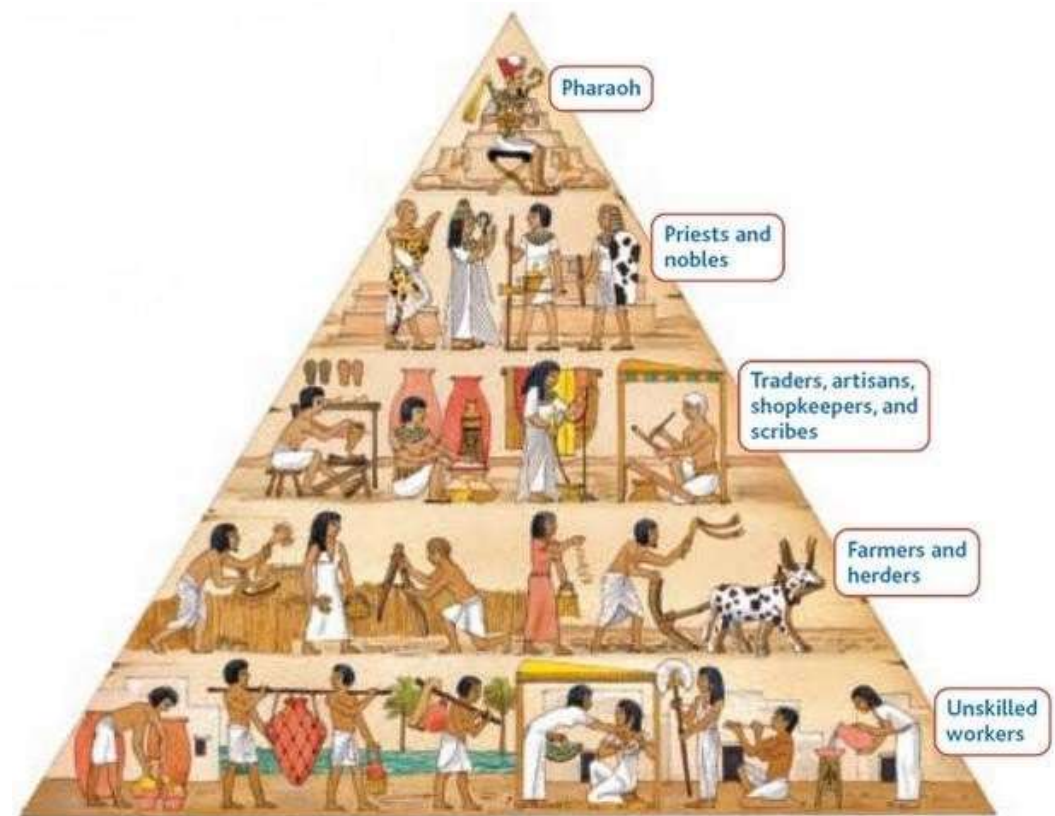
Reducing Tensions: By promoting responsibility and unity, sociology helps lessen conflicts and problems in society.

Identifying New Problems: Sociology helps us predict and tackle future issues society might face, like new types of social problems.

Social Structure

- Social structure is how society is organized, including groups of people and their roles. It helps us understand how we all relate to each other and work together.

In easy words, social structure is how people connect and fit into different groups and places in society.



Elements of Social Structure

Social structure can be broken down into differing elements: status, roles, social networks, groups, and organizations

Status: Status shows where someone stands in society or in a group. It can be shown by things like money, job title, or even just the clothes someone wears.

Roles: Roles are about what a person does and what they're expected to do. For example, someone might have the role of cleaning streets. People might judge them based on this role.

Social Networks: Social networks are the different groups of people someone connects with. These groups interact and have different levels of importance in society.

Groups and organizations provide the opportunity for much broader social structure and connections to be made.